Let's Pretend this Never Happened

By Jenny Lawson

Phone Conversation I Had with My Husband After I Got Lost for the Eighty Thousandth Time

ME: **(Pg 140-145)** Hello?

VICTOR: Where are you?! You've been gone an hour.

ME: I'm lost. Don't yell at me.

VICTOR: You went to get milk, dude. You've been to that store a hundred times.

ME: Yes, but not at night. Everything looks all strange and I couldn't see the signs. And I guess I must've taken a wrong street and I've been driving aimlessly, hoping for something to look familiar.

VICTOR: How can you get lost every time you leave the house?

ME: I don't even think I'm in Texas anymore.

VICTOR: [You have got to be kidding me!] —

ME: DON'T YELL AT ME.

INTRODUCTION

Do you know your significant other? I mean, do you really, truly, know who they are as a person? For example, when couples get really busy, they can go days without asking any questions beyond logistics-type questions. They see each other at the end of the day and ask "How was your day?" and they go through what happened. They get so wrapped up in the day-to-day – the 'how are you?' that they rarely get to the 'who are you?' But never fear . . . you can have deep, [air quotes] meaningful 'who are you' conversations with your significant other. Just like Jenny and Victor in

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VICTOR: I'm not yelling at you. Just turn on the GPS and put in our address.

ME: I left it at home.

VICTOR: WHAT IS WRONG WITH YOU?!

ME: You said you wouldn't yell at me!

VICTOR: That was before you left the GPS at home. I BOUGHT IT EXPRESSLY BECAUSE OF YOU.

ME: Can't you just tell me how to get home?

VICTOR: How am I supposed to help you get home, Jenny? I DON'T KNOW WHERE YOU ARE.

ME: Okay . . . there are a lot of trees. And bushes. Or they might be horses. It's too dark to tell.

VICTOR: Oh, yeah, I know exactly where you are.

ME: Really?

VICTOR: No. You're someplace where there may or may not be bushes. How is that helpful?

ME: I need to find a street sign.

VICTOR: You NEED to remember to put the GPS in your car.

ME: No. I'm not using it anymore.

VICTOR: Why not?!

ME: It's trying to kill me.

VICTOR: [stunned silence]

ME: Remember last week when I had to go into town and I got the driving instructions from MapQuest and you made me take the GPS as a backup, but then halfway there the GPS is all, "Turn left now," and I'm all, "No. MapQuest says to go straight," and it's like, "TURN LEFT NOW," and I'm all, "No way." and then she's sighing at me like she's frustrated and she keeps saying, "Recalculating," in this really judgy, condescending way, and then she's all, "TURN LEFT NOW!" And I'm all freaked out, so I turn left exactly like she says and then she's all, "Recalculating. Recalculating," and I'm like, "I DID EXACTLY WHAT YOU SAID TO DO. WHAT'S WITH THE TONE?"

VICTOR: You're not using the GPS because you don't appreciate the tone of the robot?

ME: No, that's just the start . . . .

VICTOR: You still haven't seen a street sign?

ME: Oh. Sorry. I kind of forgot I was driving.

VICTOR: You forgot you were driving while you were driving?

ME: It's not like I ran into a cow. I just forgot I was looking for signs.

VICTOR: If you ever make it home, I'm hiding your car keys.

ME: Anyway, that's when I came up with what might be the greatest invention in the history of the world.

VICTOR: Street signs. Look for street signs.

ME: Haven't seen any. Feels like I'm on a highway. Ask me what my great idea is.

VICTOR: No.

ME: GPS for stupid people.

VICTOR: [silence]

ME: I'm totally serious. Because I'm no good with directions, but I'm really good with landmarks, so if you tell me to go north on Main, I'm [lost], but if you say, "Turn at that Burger King that burned down last year," I totally know what to do, so we should build a GPS system that does that.

VICTOR: [sigh]

ME: And here's the genius part: We make it able to learn so it adapts to you personally. So, like, if I say, "Huh. There's a homeless guy," it'll put that in its data banks, and then when I want to go somewhere later, instead of just naming random streets it's all, "You know where that homeless guy was? We're going there. Turn left at that Sonic you like. Turn right at the burrito place you took Sarah to.

VICTOR: What the [hell]?

ME: Exactly. See, there'd be a learning curve. We'd have to put that in the brochure. Like a disclaimer.

VICTOR: How long do you have to be missing before I can start dating again?

ME: I'm just saying [it] isn't perfected yet, dude. It's close, though. OHMYGOD, I TOTALLY KNOW WHERE I AM!

VICTOR: You're at the burrito place you took Sarah to?

ME: No. I'm at that abandoned building that looks like it's owned by Branch Davidians.

VICTOR: Huh. The rest of the world calls that "Dallas Street." So can you get home now?

ME: I think so. Left at that spooky bar that looks like it's out of Scooby-Doo, left at the place we saw that wild boar that turned out to be a dog, and right at the corner where I threw up that one time. Right?

VICTOR: You make my head hurt.

ME: DUDE, WE ARE GOING TO BE MILLIONAIRES.

Hairless Rats: Free for Kids Only

ME: **(Pg 282-286)** This morning Victor and I stopped into the local gas station for coffee. On the way out we stopped in front of the public bulletin board. [There] were ads like: REGULAR SQUIRRELS—FREE TO GOOD HOME. NOT FOR EATING. RATS AND MICE CHEAP – LOCAL - CAN DELIVER 24 HRS. HAIRLESS RATS FREE FOR KIDS ONLY.

VICTOR: Wow. I don't think I want to know of the situation you have to be in where you need a rat delivered so desperately that it can't wait until morning.

ME: Ooh, I would.

VICTOR: Well, of course you would.

ME: Who wouldn't want to know about an emergency rat situation where the emergency is that you NEED a rat. It's like the exact opposite of every regular emergency rat situation ever. It sounds fascinating. We should call this guy just to see what his deal is. I bet he has great stories. I mean, who gives hairless rats to children? He's like the bizarro-world Candy Man.

VICTOR: So call him. Pretend to apply for a free squirrel and see what his story is.

ME: I wonder what the application process is on that? It would be really depressing to get turned down for free squirrels.

VICTOR: True. "I'm sorry. We're going to have to decline you. Your home isn't even fit for squirrels."

ME: Our home is pretty messy, but I think it's at least fit for squirrels. I'd be like, "But our squirrels seem quite happy." I'd totally appeal that ruling.

VICTOR: "I'm sorry, but your references didn't check out."

ME: "But our references ***were*** squirrels."

VICTOR: "Right. And they're not happy. Plus, there have been some reports of hate speech."

ME: "What?"

VICTOR: "Last week you dropped a fork and yelled, 'Rats.' Then in January you complained that your computer wasn't working properly and was acting 'all squirrelly.' We have people on the inside, you know."

ME: "Hang on. Are those people the squirrels who live in my attic? Because they're all high and they don't know what they're saying. Those squirrels are junkies and they are not to be trusted."

VICTOR: "Ma'am, that was slander. You'll be contacted by the squirrel civil liberties union for a statement. Plus, you need to stop referring to squirrels as 'those people.' Please get [it] together."

ME: Wow. We sound . . . totally unfit to have squirrels. Now I don't even want to call the guy, because I'm all nervous about being judged. I don't even think I could pass the interview. [And] I can't remember how we got to the point where I'm defending myself against the imaginary accusations of a man who gives hairless rats to neighborhood children, and who apparently trusts the nonexistent squirrel junkies in the attic.

VICTOR: True. I don't remember ever having these conversations before we moved to the country.

ME: Me either. Also, I just realized that I just went to a gas station in my pajamas to buy coffee. I just became a giant warning sign to others.

VICTOR: What the hell happened to us?

Thanks for the Zombies, Jesus -- Car conversation with Victor

ME: **(Pg 164-168)** Oh my God, did you see the name of that cemetery we just passed? "Resurrection Cemetery." What a horrible name for a cemetery.

VICTOR: It's because they believe in the resurrection of believers.

ME: Still. Some things just shouldn't be resurrected. Just what we need is a bunch of zombies wandering the earth.

VICTOR: That's not "resurrection." That's "reanimation."

ME: Same difference. Although I guess "Reanimation Cemetery" would sound way more creepy.

VICTOR: It's not the same difference. Zombies are reanimated, but they don't have their previous mental capacity. Technically that's a "zombification."

ME: Well, if you want to get all technical, then how about vampires?

VICTOR: Um . . . they're fine?

ME: What I mean is, vampires have their "previous mental capacity," thus by your logic they are "resurrected." Might as well name it "Jesus-Is- Bringing-You-Vampires Cemetery."

VICTOR: No. That's not the same thing, because when you resurrect someone from the grave they aren't undead.

ME: No, they are TOTALLY undead. That's like the very definition of the undead.

VICTOR: No. A vampire is undead. The resurrected aren't undead.

ME: I think you don't know what "undead" means.

VICTOR: I THINK YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT "UNDEAD" MEANS!

ME: Oh my God, calm down, Darwin. Don't get all crazy just 'cause I threw a vampire monkey wrench in your faulty Jesus-zombie logic.

VICTOR: [glower] . . . [Long angry silence]

ME: So, I was talking to the organ donation lady at work the other day and she told me a secret way that you can't ***not*** give away my organs.

VICTOR: You know what? I dare you to make less sense.

ME: Well, I know you're anti–organ donation, and so I told her I was afraid that you wouldn't let the doctor take my organs if I died first, but she said if I list my mom as my next of kin on my donor card then they won't even ask you for your permission.

VICTOR: If you want to throw away all your organs I won't stop you. Just don't come complaining to me when I see you in the afterlife and you're all, "Oh my God, I just peed all over myself because someone else has my bladder."

ME: Fine. And if you die first I'm totally donating your organs too.

VICTOR: Like hell you are. I may need them.

ME: Why would you need them? YOU'RE DEAD.

VICTOR: What if I become a zombie? Huh, smart-ass? I'd be a pretty [crappy] zombie if they took my eyes out. I'd be biting poles and cats and . . .

ME: So you're making a decision to not save someone's life on the off chance that it might be inconvenient if you turn into a less efficient zombie?

VICTOR: It sounds stupid when you say it.

ME: Fine. I'll just donate the parts that a zombie doesn't need. Like your skin. Or your brain tissue.

VICTOR: Zombies need brains.

ME: No, zombies eat brains. Obviously you could donate your brain and still be a functional zombie.

VICTOR: Yeah, and then I've gotta spend eternity wandering the world as a mindless idiot.

ME: [snort]

VICTOR: Shut up. If zombie-me finds out I've got parts missing you will be the very first person I eat.

ME: I wonder if this is the weirdest fight we've ever had.

VICTOR: Not. Even. Close.

FOR EDUC

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AWARD HISTORY

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